the ‘Namaste Trump’ event was responsible for the spread of the virus and deaths in Gujarat, notwithstanding the fact that even the initial cases in Gujarat came more than a fortnight after the visit.[21]

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Finally, in late February, China released the report[22] prepared by the team of scientists deployed by the WHO to investigate the virus with highly misleading information on the lines that asymptomatic spread of the infection was ‘relatively rare and does not appear to be a major driver of transmission’. The report also extensively praised China for its containment efforts adding that the country has undertaken ‘perhaps the most ambitious, agile and aggressive disease containment effort in history’. However, it also contained a stark warning: ‘Much of the global community is not ready, in mindset and materially, to implement the measures that have been employed to contain COVID-19 in China. These are the only measures that are currently proven to interrupt or minimize’ the spread of coronavirus. These were measures which included surveillance, public engagement, cancellation of mass gatherings, traffic controls, rapid diagnosis, immediate case isolation and rigorous tracking and quarantining close contacts.[23] If India had any chance of fighting the virus, all of the aforementioned measures would have to be meticulously put in place.